

State of Our Community

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gAOFBTde4to
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Comprehensive Meeting & Community Address Report

Event: 2026 Joint State of Our Community Address (City of Muncie & Delaware County)

Location: Horizon Convention Center, Muncie, Indiana

1. Pre-Hearing & Committee Work Sessions

(Not applicable to this transcript; no statutory public hearing or committee session preceded the event.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:**
 - The event began with preliminary technical countdowns and acknowledgments of the Horizon Convention Center and the audiovisual provider, AMS, starting around **00:00:09**.
 - The formal presentation commenced at **00:28:48** with opening remarks delivered jointly by **Mayor Dan Ridenour** (City of Muncie) and **Commissioner Steven Brand** (Delaware County).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officers:** Mayor Dan Ridenour and Commissioner Steven Brand.

- **Elected Officials / Dignitaries Present:** State Senator Scott Alexander, State Representative JD Prescott, State Representative Elizabeth Rowray, County Commissioner Sherrian, County Commissioner Shannon Henry, and various city council members, department heads, and local agency directors.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - A moment of personal faith and acknowledgment of family support was shared by Mayor Ridenour (00:01:02).
 - Special tributes were held featuring state legislators presenting Senate Joint Resolutions:
 - Honoring the memory of Greg Whitters via the naming of a portion of I-69 North as the "Greg Whitters Memorial Mile" (accepted by Molly and Chief Sloan) 00:39:17.
 - Honoring and memorializing the life of Corporal Blake Reynolds 00:40:51.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Not applicable to this joint community address format.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(This community address focused on administrative updates, interlocal collaborations, and economic/infrastructure achievements for 2025 and goals for 2026 rather than formal legislative votes or ordinance passages.)

- **Interlocal Collaboration & Joint Operations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour & Commissioner Steven Brand 00:02:48
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Leaders emphasized joint funding and coordination between Muncie and Delaware County across multiple essential operations, including the 911 Communication Center, the Metropolitan Planning Commission, the joint animal shelter, support for the county jail (specifically Iraqs and jump programs), road infrastructure, and expanded "Make My Move" remote worker incentives covering all Muncie mailing addresses.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote required.
- **Economic Development, Housing, & Population Growth**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour & Commissioner Steven Brand 00:06:06
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Focused on growing total payroll and population instead of raising local income tax (LIT) rates. Highlighted 1,478 new jobs added between 2020 and 2025, a 13.71% increase in income tax revenue, and residential milestones (599 new units added in 2025, with 655 planned for 2026). Major housing projects

discussed included Storewoods Estates, Village South, a mixed-rate apartment complex on the White River by TWWG, and the exclusive "Steeplechase" subdivision. Major economic opportunities in data management centers and energy generation (small modular and advanced reactors) were also outlined.

- **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote required.
- **Public Safety Department Updates & Investments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Steven Brand & Mayor Dan Ridenour [00:23:19](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed statistics and capital investments for emergency services:
 - **911 Center:** Handled nearly 60,000 emergency calls and 102,000 admin calls in 2025 (Director Fred Cummings recognized).
 - **EMA:** Completed 4 CERT trainings, hazard mitigation planning, and installed White River mile markers (Director John Cino recognized).
 - **Sheriff's Department:** Federal inmate housing programs generated nearly \$1.7 million in 2025 revenue to offset jail operating expenses (Sheriff Tony Skinner recognized).
 - **Muncie Police Department:** Handled 50,900 calls in 2025 with an extremely low 0.4% use-of-force rate, backed by 18,056 hours of training, two social workers, and community engagement officers.
 - **Muncie Fire Department:** Responded to 18,377 calls; constructed and opened Fire Station 6 (the first new fire station since 1986); added two EMS trucks and two ambulances.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote required.
- **Infrastructure, Roads, & Equipment Purchases**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Steven Brand & Mayor Dan Ridenour [00:34:52](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed highway and public works acquisitions including new sheriff vehicles, a crack-sealing machine, gradealls, bridge sweeping assets, and Peterson claw trucks acquired from the Muncie Sanitary District. Outlined extensive 2025 paving milestones and ambitious 2026 targets (including the major \$6 million Tillitson Street project, Adam Street, South Walnut, and county road improvements via Community Crossings matching grants). INDOT projects, including upcoming J-turns and roundabouts at high-accident intersections (e.g., State Road 67 & 400 South, Madison & Jackson), were also reviewed.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote required.
- **Fiscal Governance & Internal Restructuring**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Steven Brand & Mayor Dan Ridenour [00:58:56](#)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted a continuous improvement program yielding roughly \$2 million in year-over-year cost savings and avoidances (e.g., power factor correction, health insurance restructuring, and optimization of county phone lines). Addressed successful departmental transitions (HR, Engineering under new County

Engineer Dean Thomas, and IT brought in-house). Noted that the Muncie Redevelopment Commission debt was reduced from \$58 million to \$43 million without borrowing for housing developments.

- **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote required.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: Because this was a joint State of the Community address rather than a standard legislative business meeting, a traditional open public comment floor period for local ordinances did not take place. Public participation was limited to community attendance, organizational representation, and upcoming town hall listening sessions announced by the commissioners, such as the Eaton Town Hall scheduled for March 12th at 6:30 PM [11:00:10](#).)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Upcoming county commissioner town hall meetings in rural and incorporated areas (starting in Eaton on March 12th).
 - Future economic focus areas: Drone testing/manufacturing space economy, advanced manufacturing, agricultural revenue enhancement, and education workforce readiness.
- **Adjournment:**
 - The event concluded with final remarks and expressions of gratitude to city and county employees by Mayor Ridenour and Commissioner Brand at approximately [01:21:01](#).

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